



LYCEUM OF THE PHILIPPINES UNIVERSITY – LAGUNA
Makiling, Calamba City
ITC – INTRODUCTION TO COMPUTING
MIDTERM HANDS-ON EXAM



Practical: Create a Responsive Web Blog Using HTML and CSS

Name:

Date:

Year/Section:

I. Learning Objectives

- Create a properly structured HTML document using semantic elements such as header, nav, main, section, article, and footer.
- Apply external CSS to organize and style a web page.
- Use Flexbox to create a two-column article layout.
- Design a consistent navigation system across multiple web pages.
- Apply basic responsive design principles for smaller screen sizes.
- Demonstrate attention to usability, accessibility, visual hierarchy, and code organization.

II. Problem Description

Create a functional and visually appealing multi-page web blog from scratch using HTML and CSS. The website must present a chosen niche topic, such as travel, technology, sports, cars, food, education, or a personal blog. The output should demonstrate proper HTML structure, external CSS styling, organized content, responsive layout, and consistent navigation.

III. General Instructions

- Work individually unless otherwise instructed by the instructor.
- Use HTML5 and CSS3. JavaScript is optional and not required.
- Create and use a separate external CSS file named styles.css.
- Use meaningful file names, class names, headings, and image alternative text.
- Use original content or properly attributed information. Avoid using Lorem ipsum as final content.
- Test the website in a browser and correct HTML, CSS, layout, and broken-link errors.
- Keep the website folder organized. Place images in an images folder when applicable.

IV. Required Website Pages and Files

File/Page	Required Content	Minimum Requirement
index.html	Home page	Header, navigation, introduction, featured content, footer
about.html	About the blog or author	Purpose, author/blog description, consistent layout
articles.html	Article listing	At least four articles with images, titles, and summaries
contact.html	Contact page	Contact details and a basic non-functional contact form
styles.css	External styling	Shared styles for all pages

images/	Website images	Relevant images with appropriate alt text
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V. Required Design and Technical Features

Header: Use a full-width background image or banner with a readable blog title and short tagline.

Navigation: Include working links to Home, About, Articles, and Contact. Navigation must be consistent on all pages.

Main Content: Use semantic HTML elements and organize information into readable sections.

Articles: Include at least four articles. Each article must contain an image, title, summary, and relevant text.

Two-Column Layout: Use CSS Flexbox to organize article content into two columns on larger screens.

Responsive Design: Use a media query so the columns stack vertically on smaller screens.

Footer: Include social media links or placeholders, privacy/terms links, copyright information, and consistent styling.

Accessibility: Use descriptive alt attributes, logical heading order, readable contrast, and meaningful link text.

Visual Design: Apply a consistent color palette, typography, spacing, borders, and hover effects.

VI. Suggested HTML Structure

You may use the following structure as a guide. You are expected to customize the content and design.

Choose a specific niche or topic (e.g., car reviews, tourist destinations, travel adventures, sports, technology, food, or personal interests) for your web blog. Develop relevant and engaging content that reflects your chosen topic throughout the website.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>My Blog</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
</head>
<body>
  <header>
    <div class="header-image">
      <h1>Welcome to My Blog</h1>
      <p>Your source for insightful articles</p>
    </div>
    <nav>
      <ul>
        <li><a href="index.html">Home</a></li>
        <li><a href="about.html">About</a></li>
        <li><a href="articles.html">Articles</a></li>
        <li><a href="contact.html">Contact</a></li>
      </ul>
    </nav>
  </header>
```

```

<main>
  <section class="content">
    <div class="column">
      <article>
        
        <h2>Article Title</h2>
        <p>Article summary and content.</p>
      </article>
    </div>
    <div class="column">
      <article>
        
        <h2>Article Title</h2>
        <p>Article summary and content.</p>
      </article>
    </div>
  </section>
</main>

<footer>
  <p>&copy; 2026 My Blog. All rights reserved.</p>
</footer>
</body>
</html>

```

VII. Required CSS Improvements

- Use box-sizing: border-box for predictable sizing.
- Use Flexbox for the article columns.
- Use a media query such as @media (max-width: 768px) to stack columns.
- Set images to max-width: 100% so they do not overflow their containers.
- Use hover effects for navigation links.
- Maintain readable font sizes, sufficient spacing, and adequate color contrast.

VIII. Testing and Debugging Checklist

- ☐ All HTML pages open successfully in a browser.
- ☐ All navigation links point to the correct files.
- ☐ The external CSS file is correctly linked on every page.
- ☐ Images display correctly and have descriptive alt text.
- ☐ The two-column layout works on a desktop-sized screen.
- ☐ The layout stacks or adjusts on a smaller screen.
- ☐ There are no visible broken images, overlapping elements, or horizontal overflow.
- ☐ Text is readable and the header/footer are consistent across pages.

IX. Reflection Questions

1. Why is it important to use semantic HTML elements such as header, nav, main, section, article, and footer instead of using only generic div elements?

Response: _____

2. How does using an external CSS file improve code organization, consistency, and maintainability when a website contains multiple pages?

Response: _____

3. Explain how Flexbox was used to create the two-column article layout. What changes were needed to make the layout responsive on smaller screens?

Response: _____

4. How did your choice of color scheme, typography, spacing, and images contribute to the usability and visual appeal of your blog?

Response: _____

5. What problems or errors did you encounter while developing and testing your website? Describe the steps you took to identify and resolve them.

Response: _____

6. If you were given more time to improve your blog, what feature or design improvement would you add, and why would it benefit the users?

Response: _____

X. Submission Requirements

- Submit the complete project folder containing all HTML files, styles.css, and image files. You can use your Codespace on your Github and include the link in your submission.
- Ensure that all pages and links work when the folder is opened locally.
- Submit screenshots showing the desktop layout and responsive/mobile layout.
- Include the completed answers to all six reflection questions.
- Follow the instructor's file naming and submission instructions.

XI. Rubric for Grading

Criteria	Description	Points
HTML Structure and Semantics	Correct structure and appropriate semantic elements	20
CSS and Layout	External CSS, Flexbox, spacing, typography, and styling	20
Functionality and Navigation	Working pages, links, images, and consistent header/footer	20
Responsive Design and Accessibility	Mobile layout, readable design, alt text, and usability	15
Content and Creativity	Relevant niche, meaningful content, and personalized design	15
Testing, Debugging, and Organization	Error correction, organized files, and successful browser testing	10
Total		100